

CENTERING OUR GOVERNANCE

Forging a Foundation In Service of Students

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bombastic

OUR AFTERNOON TOGETHER

- Welcome & setting the stage
- Deepening understanding on the Board's role and responsibilities
- Building coherence for effective governing
- Wrapping up and next steps



The goal is not to be perfect by the end. The goal is to be better today.

– **SIMON SINEK**

CONVERSATION SCAFFOLDS

01 Stay Engaged

02 Foster Individual & Collective Dignity

03 Make Space for Everyone

04 "Yes, and..." over "No, but..."

05 Don’t let the Perfect be the enemy of the Good

BOARD ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

What we can learn from the OSBA Standards and research into Board best practices.



THE "WHAT" AND THE "HOW" IN THE OSBA STANDARDS

"WHAT"

01 Vision-director Planning

02 Community Engagement

04 Accountability

08 Learning Organization

12 Budgeting & Financial Administration

"HOW"

03 Effective Leadership

05 Data Driven Improvement

06 Cultural Responsiveness

07 Culture and Climate

09 Systems Thinking

10 Innovation and Creativity

11 Board Conduct and Relationships

"THE SCIENCE OF STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT"

What research tells us about the Board's impact on student growth.



The Science of Student Achievement

...g to Board ...mpacts ...nt

Improving student achievement became the mission for public education more than a decade ago, putting educators, including school boards, on notice. Decades of research provided teachers and administrators with a vast amount of information to consult. School boards, on the other hand, had little to turn to. Already saddl... with traditional duties such as budget, policy, and contract negotia... school boards across America were challenged to find ways of participating in districtwide efforts to raise achievement sc... students.

If student achievement scores are the ultimate ... for public schools, districts would need to ide... under their control and align them in ... challenge for researchers was ... challenge for sch...

APPLYING WHAT WE ARE LEARNING

"Oversight Versus Overstep" scenarios



IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

1. During a board meeting, several Board Members have questions about expenditures that were in the budget they approved, including the purchase of new technology for the high school. Board Members are curious about how the money was spent, and they want to make sure that teachers are receiving professional development so they know how to teach with new technology.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

2. A community member stopped you in the store because they received an email from another Board Member sent from the school district email account, supporting a specific board candidate in the upcoming election. The community member wondered if this candidate's support was a stance the entire Board had taken since it came from the school email account.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

3.As the first budget was presented to the public, the room fills with youth and adults. It becomes clear that the proposed cut to the baseball program is going to create some upset folks. During the meeting, the Chair requested the Superintendent and business manager present a budget outlining various options other than baseball by the next budget work session that was on the schedule for next week.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

4. A parent stops a Board member in the supermarket and accuses his child's school of not providing the special education services that his special needs child is entitled to. The Board member suggests that this parent contact the special education director to discuss their concerns.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

5. Your Board just voted, and it was a split vote. You were not on the prevailing side of the issue. When you leave the meeting, a community member stops you and asks you how you feel about being on the 'losing' side. You indicate it was a horrible decision, and you will not be quiet about your disapproval of this decision.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

6. The Board is discussing the upcoming budget process at a work session. A board member brings up that there is no mention of district goals or the strategic plan in the process. They remember that during a board training presentation on budget, the budget should be tied to the district's strategic plan.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

7. A community member contacts a Board member accusing some employees of inappropriate and illegal conduct and demands that the Board member fire those employees immediately. The Board member indicates that they will 'take care' of this issue as soon as they can meet with the superintendent.

IS THIS OVERSIGHT, OVERSTEPPING, 'NO BIG DEAL' OR JUST NOT A GOOD IDEA?

8. A Board member wants a detailed, comprehensive report, including a school to school comparison, on programs that increase achievement at the elementary level and the data to show their effectiveness.



BREAK

"If you think you are too small to make a difference, try sleeping with a mosquito."

CENTERING GOVERNANCE WITHIN THE COMPLEXITY



"TRUST MATTERS"



SOME OTHER VIEWS OF THE VALUE OF WORKING AS A GOVERNING BODY



GROUP AGREEMENTS

A conversation about how to support deliberations and build trust while governing.

- Think of a time when you felt part of a high-functioning team. What behaviors made that possible?
- How do we want to handle learning moments or missteps?



LOOKING FORWARD: PREPARING TO STRENGTHEN

How can we work together to **identify areas** in our joint work that are not aligned with all that we've discussed today?



CHARTING THE COURSE AHEAD

E = Excited About

W = Worried About

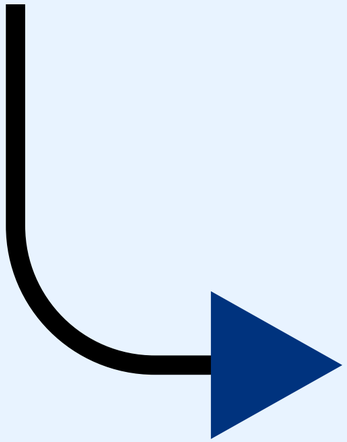
N = Needs More Information

S = Suggestion / Next Step



THANK YOU FOR OUR TIME TOGETHER.

We'd appreciate your feedback.





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